

BIRD IDENTIFICATION

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# Quick Notes

**BANK SWALLOWS** have a brown chest band



**BLACK VULTURES** have white wing tips

**GREATER BLACK-BACKED GULL** has pink legs

**GRACKLES** have a much longer tail than **RUSTYS**

**KESTRALS** have sideburns & some orange

**RAVENS** have wedge shaped tail (Crows have rounded)

# FINCHES

## PURPLE



- No Streaks on breast
- Straight Bill
- White Eye Strip



## HOUSE



- No Streaks on breast
- Curved Bill
- Rounder Head



# FLYCATCHERS

## SONGS

**Acadian** Sharp explosive *pit-see!*  
or *wee-see!*

**Least** Emphatic sharp *che-bek!*

**Willow** Sneezy *fitx-bew*

**Alder** Accented *fee-B-o*  
or *rree-BE-o*  
or *free beer*

**OLIVE SIDED** has clear breast



**PHOEBE'S** have a long tail



# SPARROWS

|                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                              | <b>CLEAR BREAST</b>                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| WHITE Face                                                   | <b>WHITE THROATED</b><br>Brushy forest edges<br>With yellow on face                                                                                                                                            |
| WHITE Face                                                   | <b>WHITE CROWNED</b><br>NO WHITE THROAT<br>                                                                                   |
| No Red Cap<br><br>YELLOW bill<br>base<br><br><br>Medium Size | <b>SWAMP</b><br>Wetlands - <b>All year long</b><br>base of bill is yellow; grey face<br>♪ Trill song (like chipping ) ♪<br> |
|                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

|           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |        |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Rusty Cap | <p><b>FIELD</b></p> <p>  <br/>           plain face, white eye-ring<br/> <b>PINK BILL</b> </p>  | Fields |
| Red Cap   | <p><b>CHIPPING</b></p> <p>Apr-Oct<br/> <i>Dark line continuing thru eyes</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                  |        |
| Red Cap   | <p><b>AMERICAN TREE</b></p> <p>Oct-Apr<br/>           Rusty eyeline (not black)<br/>           Black &amp; yellow bill</p>                                                    |        |

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LARGE bill     | <div>GRASSHOPPER</div> <div>Open Fields – summer, early fall</div> <div>       . . . . .   .   .     </div> <div>Yellow above eye</div> <div>♪ Two intro notes + trill ♪</div> <div>  </div> |
| WHITE eye ring |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Small          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| SHORT tail     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                 |       |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
|       | FINE STREAKED BREAST                                                                                                                                                            |       |
|       | LINCOLN'S                                                                                                                                                                       | Brush |
| SMALL | <div>   .   .     . .       . . —     .   </div> <div>♪ Wren-loke song ♪</div> <div>  </div> |       |



|                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|                                                                                                                          | <b>STREAKED BREAST</b>                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| <p>LARGE bird</p> <p>some blue-gray on the head/neck,</p> <p>heavy/ messy streaking that becomes crisper lower down.</p> | <p><b>FOX</b></p> <p>Boreal Forest</p>   |  |
| <p>YELLOW eye patch</p> <p>PINK bill</p> <p>SHORT notched TAIL</p>                                                       | <p><b>SAVANNAH</b></p> <p>Fields</p>     |  |
|                                                                                                                          | <b>SONG</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| <p>PINK bill</p> <p>WHITE eye ring</p> <p>WHITE tail feathers</p> <p>ROUFUS shoulder</p>                                 | <p><b>VESPER</b></p>                                                                                                     |  |



|  |  |
|--|--|
|  |  |
|--|--|

# SWALLOWS, MARTINS

**TREE** - *clean white underside*  
*sharp contrast between cheek & throat*



**NORTHERN ROUGH WING** - *brownish throat*  
*that does not contrast with cheeks*



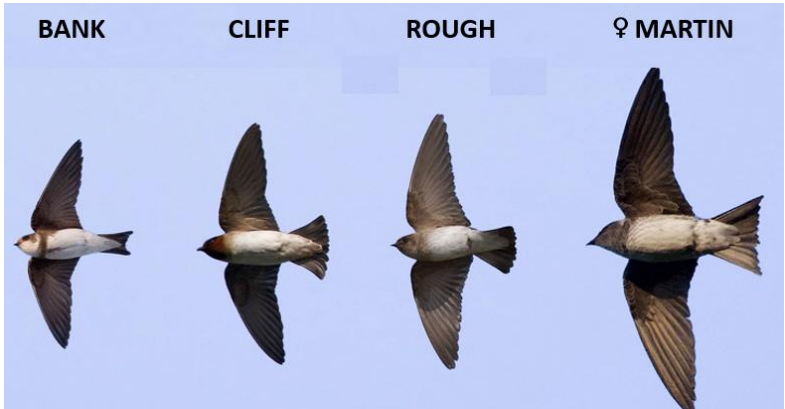
**PURPLE MARTIN**  
dark throat and long tail feathers



**CLIFF**  
dark throat, colorful, white forehead



**BARN** – forked wings, blue upperside, orange underside  
**BANK** –has chest band



# THRUSHES

**Veery** - Very clear breast  
uniformly reddish-brown upperparts,  
indistinct breast spotting, pale eye-ring  
smaller than robin



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**Hermit** – Half chest spots  
- thin white eye ring,  
- distinct spots on chest that fade



sustained whistle & soft echo-like song

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**Wood** – large, bolder spots  
sings like a **wood**wind flute



# WARBLERS



**Yellow** – streaks



**Palm** – Orange crown



**Yellow Rumped**



**Black & White**



**COMMON YELLOWTHROAT** -throat



**HOODED** – crown and throat

# WOODPECKERS

## HAIRY vs DOWNY



Hairy (left) and Downy Woodpecker. Illustrations: Roger Tory Peterson

- Hairy has all white tail feathers
- Hairy has longer beak
- Hairy prefers tall trees and deeper woods

## YELLOW BELLIED SAPSUCKER



- Males have red throat
- Vertical white wing patches

## NORTHERN FLICKER



- Black throat & white rump

## RED BELLIED NORTHERN FLICKER



## RED HEADER WOODPECKER





# WRENS

## CAROLINA WREN



## HOUSE WREN



- Smallest
- Dark barring on wings, paler throat

## WINTER WREN



- Forests
- Weak pale eyebrow
- Holds tail up
- ♪ warble with trills

# SONGBIRD SONGS

- **Red-eyed Vireos** sing a rapid series of short, repeated phrases, "here I am, where are you?"
- **American Robins** sing more varied w/extended phrases and pauses "cheer-up, cheerily".

MISC

|                                         |                               |                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>WATERFOWL</b>                        |                               |                                                                                    |
| No white on neck or under chin          | <b>Red Breasted Merganser</b> |  |
| <b>SHORE BIRDS</b>                      |                               |                                                                                    |
| Drooping Bill, Black legs               | <b>Dunlin</b>                 |  |
| Chunky, Orange base of bill             | <b>Purple Sandpiper</b>       |                                                                                    |
| <b>WARBLERS</b>                         |                               |                                                                                    |
| Black streaks on body, white wing bars  | <b>Black Throated Green</b>   |                                                                                    |
| Black Necklace & White eyes             | <b>Canada</b>                 |                                                                                    |
| Looks like goldfinch, but white eyering | <b>Chestnut sided</b>         |                                                                                    |
|                                         |                               |                                                                                    |

